

Document Order & Cross-Verification Guide

The exact document order visa officers expect, plus the cross-checks that catch the errors behind roughly 30% of avoidable rejections.

The Recommended Document Order

#	Section	Documents in this order
1	Cover & Checklist	Index page -> embassy's official checklist (ticked off) -> cover letter (optional)
2	Application Form	Completed visa form -> confirmation page -> photos attached -> signature page
3	Appointment & Fees	Interview appointment letter -> visa fee receipt -> SEVIS/IHS payment -> biometrics receipt
4	Passport & Identity	Passport biodata copy -> extra photos -> national ID -> birth certificate -> previous visas
5	University Documents	Admission letter -> I-20/CAS/COE -> fee payment receipt -> scholarship letter -> course details
6	Financial Proof	Bank statements (newest first) -> sponsorship letter -> loan sanction -> tax returns
7	Academic Records	Latest degree -> transcripts -> mark sheets -> IELTS/TOEFL -> recommendation letters
8	Medical Documents	TB certificate -> medical exam report -> vaccination records -> health insurance proof
9	Supporting Documents	Statement of Purpose -> work experience letters -> travel history -> family ties

Cross-Document Verification

Name Verification

Exact spelling on every page - check passport, visa form, bank statements, admission letter, and every certificate.

Common issue: "Ram Kumar Sharma" vs "Ram K. Sharma" vs "R.K. Sharma" across different documents.

Date Verification

Birth date matches everywhere - passport, birth certificate, academic records, and bank accounts.

Common issue: DD/MM/YYYY vs MM/DD/YYYY confusion between documents from different systems.

Address Verification

Current address is consistent across your visa form, bank statements, utility bills, and ID cards.

Common issue: different addresses appearing on different documents without explanation.

Financial Consistency

Sponsor income matches tax returns; bank balance supports the tuition figure; loan amount covers any shortfall.

Common issue: claimed funds don't actually match what the bank statements show.

The Name Mismatch Fix

If your name is spelled differently across your passport and your certificates (a very common issue), get a notarized affidavit stating both spellings refer to the same person - and submit it proactively, before an officer has to ask.